



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2020/2021

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF
EDUCATION, BACHELOR OF ARTS, BACHELOR OF SCIENCE, BACHELOR OF
COMMERCE AND BACHELOR OF ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES

UCU 100: COMMUNICATION SKILLS

DATE: Friday 12th March 2021

TIME: 2.00p.m. - 4.00p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Candidates **MUST** write their registration number in the space provided on each answer booklet and in the spaces provided in the answer booklet.
2. There are **FOUR (4)** Questions in this paper. Candidates **MUST** answer **ALL FOUR** Questions.
3. All answers **MUST** be written in the answer booklet provided

Q1 - READING COMPREHENSION (25 Marks)

Read this passage and answer the questions that follow it.

1 Our lives are routinely defined by efforts to minimize any occurrence that has the potential to bring about discomfort to us. A major problem lies with this seemingly easy human endeavour. In the 1950's Leon Festinger proposed the theory of dissonance as a means to explain the linkage between what we feel is appropriate human action and how we behave in regard with the knowledge we possess. For example consider the following attitudes and behaviours: attitude towards cancer and smoking and COVID 19; healthy teeth and brushing, maternal health and early pregnancy, road safety and drunken driving and numerous other examples. These are examples of dissonance. Dissonance refers to an inconsistency between an attitude and a behavior or a set of attitudes and any corresponding number of behaviours in an individual. Festinger argues that any form of inconsistency is uncomfortable and that individuals will attempt to reduce the dissonance, hence the discomfort. This means that they try to seek a stable state in which there is a minimum of dissonance.

2 It is not absolutely possible to eliminate dissonance completely. There are many people who know cheating on income tax is wrong, but nonetheless they still go ahead to "fudge" with numbers a bit every year and hope they do not get audited. You may tell your children to brush their teeth after a meal but *you* do not. The Ministry of Health has released safety guideless for COVID 19 which many don't strictly follow. So how do people cope? Festinger proposes that the desire to reduce dissonance would be determined by the importance of the elements creating the dissonance, the degree of influence an individual believes he or she has over the elements, and the rewards that may be involved in dissonance.

3 It is easy in life to exercise ones power over some elements than over others. Let us look at the case of a female who is 60 pounds overweight. She is single up to this point and is suspicious that her plump figure is off putting and is to a very large extent responsible for the low rate of attractiveness for the many males that seem to be everywhere she goes. The question here is, does she feel she has power to reduce her weight and thus reduce dissonance in order to attract a suitable male? What if the doctor warned her that she would be dead in less than five years if she did not cut her weight? How important is the perceived reward of being lean with an attractive date or being lean and buying yourself a longer lifespan? Rewards motivate the degree to which individuals are motivated to reduce dissonance. Of these two examples which has a higher reward? Staying alive or getting a suitor? The doctor's pressure to reduce dissonance would be less than if she was to try and lose weight voluntarily. This means effort to reduce dissonance is minimal when the individual regards the importance of what he or she stands to gain.

4 These moderating factors suggest that just because individuals experience dissonance does not automatically mean that they will move towards consistency, that is, towards the reduction of this dissonance. If the issues underlying the dissonance are of minimal importance, if the individual perceives that that the dissonance is externally imposed and is substantially uncontrollable by him or her, or if rewards are significant enough to offset the dissonance, the individual will not be under great tension to reduce the dissonance.

- a) Suggest a suitable title for this passage. (3 marks)
- b) What suitable word of your own could mean as "potential" in paragraph one. (3 marks)
- c) Using your own words, briefly explain the meaning of "dissonance". (3 marks)
- d) Festinger is the author of this passage. True or false. Support. (3 marks)
- e) What does author mean by "fudge"? (3 marks)
- f) Give one example of an element from the passage (3 marks)
- g) "These moderating factors" State two of these factors. (4 marks)
- h) In not more than two lines, explain the meaning of "the individual will not be under great tension to reduce the dissonance" from paragraph 4 (3 marks)

2. WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

- 1. Briefly explain why a plan is a very important tool when you are writing an academic essay. (2 marks)
- 2. You have been asked to write an academic essay whose topic is: **FACTORS THAT INFLUENCE UNIVERSITY STUDENTS' LEARNING.**
 - i. Write a plan based on that topic. (8 marks)

Your plan should have the following:

- a) The topic
- b) A thesis statement
- c) Introduction
- d) Three body paragraphs
- e) Conclusion.

3. In not more than 200 words write a conclusion for the essay that is based on your plan 2 (i)-e above. (10 marks)

3. **LIBRARY SKILLS - (15 Marks)**

Author (year) (Name) place / publisher

- a) Write five parts of a reference. (5 marks)
- b) Explain the ways in which focusing your essay topic helps you in searching for relevant information in the library. (3 marks)
- c) What is a call number? (2 marks)
- d) Re-write the item below in APA style:-The costing of educational plans. Paris: UNESCO. (1967). UNESCO. (5 marks)

4. **STUDY SKILLS (10 Marks)**

- a) What three factors should you consider when choosing a place study. (3 marks)
- b) Jane has problems finding her notes when she needs to study for her assignments and tests. Using two points, advise her on what she should do. (2 marks)
- c) State and explain three advantages of belonging to a study group. (3 marks)
- d) Early and preparation before you begin examinations will make you do well in them. Give two reasons why this is true. (2 marks)



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ARCHITECTURE, BACHELOR OF REAL ESTATE, BACHELOR OF
CONSTRUCTION MANAGEMENT, BACHELOR OF URBAN AND REGIONAL
PLANNING AND BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING
UCU 110: COMMUNICATION AND COLLABORATION SKILLS

DATE: Friday 12th February 2021

TIME: 2.00p.m - 4.00p.m

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Candidates MUST write their registration number in the space provided on each answer booklet. *purpose*
2. There are FIVE (5) questions in this paper. Candidates must answer ALL five questions.
3. All answers must be written in the answer booklet provided

When read a detective story, a cardinal objective is to get lost in the experience; when we read Samsung Phone's operating manual, we follow and memorize. In both instances, one need not to question what they read and contentment is realized if one is entertained and the phone starts to function as expected. It is like boarding a bus: we get on and then get off. However, if a similar attitude were to be applied to reading a newspaper, it would mean we accept everything or nothing. In critical reading, text has to be approached with both a skeptical and informed attitude and the reader in this case knows what standards to apply to determine the reliability of their reasoning and the information read. A critical reader can read six arguments presented for and against given proposition in a voter's pamphlet and quickly decide which is the soundest. As a television viewer, a critical reader is immune to commercial and political propaganda. A critical reader interacts with information.

Learning critical reading involves the ability to exercise two different mental attitudes in two different stages. In the first one, the rule of receptivity-maintaining an openness-that can ensure accurate comprehension is an overriding aim and never questioning or challenging at this initial phase. Instead the reader has to ensure an accurate mental reconstruction of the information. Judgment is suspended than as it would interfere with the concentration needed to correctly decipher works and meaning. When handling complex and unfamiliar subject matter, the process of accurate comprehending demand a number of reading to attain.

Although it is beyond the scope of this text to reach reading comprehension skills, one can learn a great deal independently by cultivating the habit of mental receptivity in the first stage of reading. If one does not remain open, there is a strong tendency to alter or distort what ever appears before us. Receptive reading does not distort the message by subsisting words or ideas, but faithfully and accurately take note of exactly what is said regardless of when or not agrees with the reader's personal, values, experiences or expectations.

In reading many books at various times in our lives, we may not feel receptive to many of the arguments we will encounter. Whenever an argument goes against our values, it is often painful to hear it out. We tend to look for reasons that will support the views we already hold rather than consider alternative views. Both effort and discipline are needed to maintain neutrality, even with what we favour. But although neutrality and objectivity can never be perfectly achieved, its should be understood as the practice of holding off personal reactions.

- a) Using not more than four words, provide a suitable title to the passage. [3 marks]
- b) Identify one word from the passage that suitably described the first attitude in reading critically. [3 marks]
- c) In not more than one line, explain what happens when a teacher interacts with information. [3 marks]
- d) What is the main reason for step one in critical reading? Answer using two words form the passage. [3 marks]
- e) What qualities are expected of a critical reader in order to achieve objectivity? [3 marks]

Question 2

WRITING SKILLS (15 MARKS)

[2 marks]

1. Briefly explain the **main purpose** of academic writing.
2. Academic writing has been described as a lengthy as well as creative process involving **various stages**.

i) List **four** stages

3. Imagine your topic for the end of semester five paragraph **essay**/topic is : **THE MAIN ADVANTAGES OF ONLINE TEACHING IN INTUITIONS OF HIGHER LEARNING IN KENYA**

[5 marks]

i) Write a plan of your essay.

[6 marks]

ii) Write a 200 words **concluding paragraph**.

Question 3

STUDY SKILLS (10 MARKS)

- a) John is a first year student who does not understand why he should budget for stationery and other items that he needs for his studies at Kenyatta university. Give him two reasons why budgeting is important. [2 marks]
- b) Advice John on which three items are important and so should be prioritized in his budget. Give a reason for each. [6 marks]
- c) When revising, it is important to make revision aids, Name two that you would make. [2 marks]

Question 4

INFORMATION LITERACY AND ETHICS (10 MARKS)

- a) Identify TWO reasons for acknowledging sources of information in your essay. [2 marks]
- b) Name the FIVE parts of a reference. [2 ½ marks]
- c) Re-write the following references using the American Psychology Association (APA) Style:

i) Allergies in Children, New York 1988. Random, American Allergy Association.
[2 ½ marks]

- ii) How to use your reading in Essays by Jeanne Godfrey, 2013. Palgrave Macmillan, 2nd edition, New York. [3 marks]

Question 5

COLLABORATION SKILLS (10 MARKS)

One of the defined working together towards common goal. This process is not always smooth.

- a) List two possible barriers to effective collaboration in students' study groups. [4 marks]
- b) For each barrier in (a), identify one solution. [4 marks]
- c) Define social loafing. [2 marks]